



Lowercase keys are now visible

across its Public Beta programs, Apple has included a switch to give users an option to choose whether or not to toggle the case appearance of the keyboard.

To use this, go to Settings - General - Accessibility - Show Lowercase Keys. You can choose to switch it on or off, depending on whichever way that seems convenient for you. While the lowercase letters do appear slightly more spaced-out and large, the appearance is not really jarring, and many users might actually prefer to see lowercase keys, which makes typing more convenient, visually.



Select side-switch functionality

The side switch has become multifunctional, and can now toggle between orientation lock and its native mute/ringer selection. Previously, the orientation lock on iOS devices was built into the Control Center, which could also be accessed when the device was locked. To enable multi-functionality of the side-switch, go to Settings - General - Use Side Switch To. You get two options to select: Lock Rotation and Mute.

For users who prefer typing in portrait mode, frequently play videos on the device and

keeps the phone in either mute or ringer mode all the time, the hardware switch will come particularly handy as switching orientation lock in the middle videos will not require the Control Center to be swiped up, thereby pausing playback.

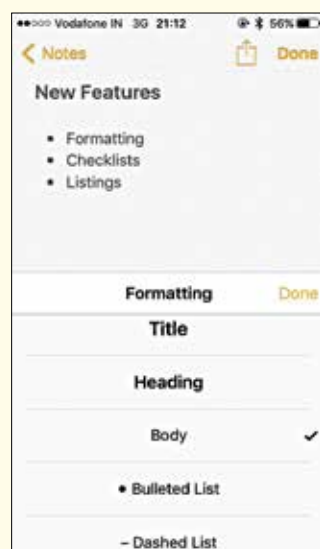


Enhance boring, old Notes with custom scribbles

Notes is one of the biggest functionality upgrades that Apple has given to any of its native applications. While the option to add photos and videos to text was added previously, the iOS 9 rendition of Notes allows you to add titles, headings, sub-headings, bulleted lists, checklists, bold/italicisation of content, and scribbling.

Select Title, Headline and Body text format

By default, the structure of notes will have the first line of a note formatted as title, following which it shifts to body. You can change parts by double-tapping on the line that you want to change, and then tapping on the Aa icon to open up the list of writing types. These represent titles (written in bigger, bold-type font size), headlines (smaller than titles, bold) and body (reg-



The new Notes screen

ular). You also get the option to further toggle the font type, by double-tapping on the desired area and hitting the right arrow to bring up the 'BIU' option, which bolds, italicises and/or underlines the desired text area.

Choose bulleted lists and Checklist

The list of writing types also has three different bullet lists, and the option to include a checklist in your note.

Add custom scribble and signatures

Additionally, you can now include a custom scribble to your note. Tap on the + symbol right above the keyboard, and tap on the scribble icon to open up the scribble window. There are three pen options, and ruler and an eraser to add basic illustration/custom signature to the note. Once done, tap on Done, and your illustration will be added at the bottom of the note. You can also choose to place the scribble at any point of your note, by hitting return and continuing typing on the same note.



Conserve battery with Low Power mode

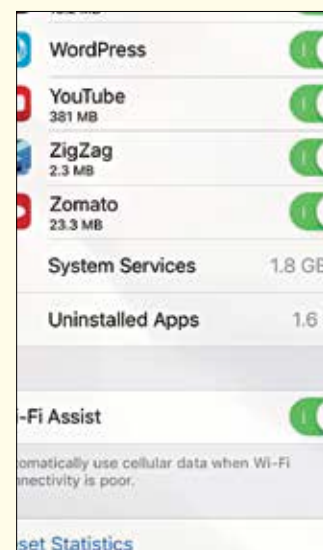
The Low Power mode is a particularly welcome addition to the iOS ecosystem, with the dubious battery life of iPhones and iPads. The Low Power mode stops push mail, background app refreshing, automatic downloads and certain visual enhancements to preserve battery life. You can choose to keep it on at any given point, and is indicated by the battery bar, which turns yellow when in Low Power mode. By default, Low Power mode will get switched on when your iOS device's battery life hits 20 per cent or below. While being charged, the Low Power mode is switched off by default once the device is charged up to at least 80 per cent.

To manually access the setting, go to Settings - Battery - Low Power Mode. The power saving mode significantly increases the battery life of your device, which is already enhanced by iOS 9 which is relatively lenient on resources in comparison to iOS 8. Keeping Low Power mode all day easily sees an iPhone 5s through an entire day's usage with WiFi always connected, and returns home after a 12-hour day with almost 20 per cent power left. A notable improvement.



Enable Wi-Fi assist for seamless connectivity

Keeping WiFi assist switched on will automatically switch you to cellular data when WiFi signal strength and reception is poor,



Switch on Wi-Fi Assist

thereby giving you seamless connectivity. Alternatively, you can choose to switch off WiFi assist, to conserve cellular data. The WiFi assist will allow seamless transition of networks, so that you don't have to worry about constant network drops.

To access this, go to Settings - Cellular. Scrolling down to the bottom of the page will pop up the Wi-Fi Assist option, which can be toggled on/off.